

Lease first; preserve an option

25 MW is not yet justified

No long-term computing commitments. No binding grid offer. Return construction for more evidence; approve only capped feasibility and competitive leasing.

Size the service from useful demand

91.104m GPU-hours / year

Illustrative base demand at 65% utilisation. 16,000 GPUs, 20 MW IT and 1.25 PUE imply a 25 MW envelope. Validate with benchmarks and signed reservations.

Compare the same compute output

£2.54 / £2.51 / £2.42

Build / lease / hybrid cost per productive GPU-hour. Includes separate facility and fleet investment, bridge leases, operations, interest and refreshes over ten years.

Test the downside before funding it

Delay +12 months / half demand

Extra bridge leasing and carry cost under grid delay. Installed capacity stays stranded when utilisation halves. A 48-hour outage also needs fuel and cooling, not just generators.

Demand, grid and price can change the answer

Three gates before construction

Signed 3+ year demand; binding connection scope and dates; performance-matched supplier bids. Keep the full build unapproved until all three are evidenced.

Committee questions

What evidence is enough?

Why build rather than lease? Who covers member withdrawal? Can the site survive 48 hours without grid power? What would reverse the recommendation?